

Career Intel Board

Conditional formatting cheat card / LHUM400, Week 9

Turning on conditional formatting

- 1 Select the column or range you want to format (click the column letter, or drag across cells).
- 2 Menu: Format > Conditional formatting. A panel opens on the right.
- 3 Under “Format rules,” choose Single color (highlight cells that meet one rule) or Color scale (a gradient across a range of numbers).
- 4 Set the condition, pick a color, click Done. Add another rule with “+ Add another rule” if you need more than one.

Track A: color scale for best-fit options

Use this on a numeric column like pay range or a 1-5 fit score. Color scale automatically shades low to high, no formula needed.

- 1 Format rules: Color scale.
- 2 Min point, midpoint, max point: leave on default (min/max of the range) unless you want a fixed scale.
- 3 Pick a preset (green-yellow-red works well for “higher is better” columns) or set your own three colors.

Role / Company	Pay Range	Entry Barrier	Fit (1-5)
example: session drummer, local studios	\$150-400/session	Low	4

Track B: rule-based flags for follow-up

Use this on your Last Contact Date column so overdue follow-ups turn red automatically.

- 1 Format rules: Single color, condition “Date is before,” value “Exact date” ... or use the custom formula option below for a rolling 30-day window.
- 2 Custom formula for a moving 30-day flag: Format rules > Custom formula is >

`=TODAY() - B2 > 30`

(swap B2 for the first cell in your Last Contact Date column, then apply to the full column). Set the fill color to red or orange.

Contact	How You Know Them	Last Contact	Status	Next Step
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example: former internship supervisor	Summer internship, 2025	6/2/2026	Warm	Send portfolio link
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Color key for the Status column: green fill for Warm or Active, gray for Cold, red for anything overdue on Last Contact.

Stuck?

Whoever in your group was here last week for the spreadsheets intro, you're the guide for this step. Everyone else, drive the keyboard while they talk you through it.